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SUPERSEDING
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MILITARY SPECIFICATION

SEMITRAILER, LOWBED: 12 TON, HYDRAULIC LIFT PLATFORM, COMMERCIAL

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

* 1.1 Scope. This specification covers a two-wheel lowbed semitrailer with a hydraulic lifting platform having a 24,000 pound payload capacity. Semitrailers procured under this specification shall be warranted by the manufacturer, as specified in acquisition documents.

* 2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Specifications and standards. The following specifications and standards form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents shall be those listed in that issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DoDISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation.

SPECIFICATIONS
FEDERAL

*	W-B-131	- Battery, Storage: Vehicular, Ignition, Lighting and Starting.
*	ZZ-T-381	- Tires, Pneumatic, Vehicular (Highway).

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: US Army Tank-Automotive Command, ATTN: AMSTA-UED, Warren, MI 48397-5000, by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

AMSC N/A FSC-2330

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MIL-P-514	- Plates, Identification, Instruction and Marking, Blank.
MIL-M-43719	- Marking Materials and Markers, Adhesive Elastronic, Pigmented; General Specifications For.

STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED-STD-297	- Rustproofing of Commercial (Nontactical) Vehicles.

MILITARY

MIL-STD-1223	- Nontactical Wheeled Vehicles Treatment, Painting, Rustproofing, Identification Marking, and Data Plate Standards.
MS75020	- Connector, Plug, Electrical - 12-Contact, Intervehicular, 28-Volt, Waterproof.
MS75021	- Connector, Receptacle, Electrical - 12-Contact, Intervehicular, 28-Volt, Waterproof.

2.1.2 Other Government documents. The following other Government documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues shall be those in effect on the date of the solicitation.

DEPARTMENT OF TRANSPORTATION (DoT)
Federal Motor Carrier Safety Regulations.
Federal Motor Vehicle Safety Standards.

(Application for copies of DoT publications should be addressed to the Department of Transportation, Federal Highway Administration, Washington, D.C. 20591.)

(Copies of specifications, standards and other Government documents required by contractors in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

* 2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of the documents which are DoD adopted shall be those listed in the issue of the DoDISS specified in the solicitation. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of documents not listed in the DoDISS shall be the issue of the nongovernment document which is current on the date of the solicitation.

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SAE, INC.
SAE Standards and Recommended Practices

	J318	- Air Brake Gladhand Service (Control) and Emergency (Supply) Line Couplers - Trucks, Truck-Tractors, and Trailers. (DoD adopted).
	J551	- Performance Levels and Methods of Measurement of Electromagnetic Radiation From Vehicles and Devices (20-1000 MHz).
*	J350	- Spark Arrester Test Procedure for Medium Size Engines. (DoD adopted).
	J560	- Seven-Conductor Electrical Connector for Truck-Trailer Jumper Cable.
	J588	- Turn Signal Lamps.
*	J682	- Rear Wheel Splash and Stone Throw Protection. (DoD adopted).
	J700	- Fifth Wheel Kingpin - Commercial Trailers and Semitrailers. (DoD adopted).
	J702	- Brake and Electrical Connection Locations Truck-Tractor and Truck Trailer.
	J844	- Nonmetallic Air Brake System Tubing. (DoD adopted).
	J1149	- Metallic Air Brake System Tubing and Pipe.
	J1292	- Automobile, Truck, Truck Tractor, Trailer and Motor Coach Wiring.
	J1401	- Hydraulic Brake Hose - Automotive.
	J1402	- Automotive Air Brake Hose and Hose Assemblies.

(Application for copies of SAE publications should be addressed to SAE, Inc., 400 Commonwealth Drive, Warrendale, PA 15096.)

THE TIRE AND RIM ASSOCIATION, INC.
Yearbook.

(Application for copies should be addressed to The Tire and Rim Association, Inc., 3200 W. Market Street, Akron, OH 44313.)

(Industry association specifications and standards are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

* 2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this specification and the references cited herein, (except for associated detail specifications, specification sheets or MS standards) the text of this specification shall take precedence. Nothing in this

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specification, however, shall supersede applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

* 3.1 Standard vehicle and accessories. Except as specified in 3.1.1 through 3.1.1.5, vehicle, components, assemblies, and accessories to be delivered under the contract shall be the manufacturer's standard or optional items, which meet or exceed the requirements of this specification. All vehicle items shall be as represented and rated in the vehicle and equipment manufacturer's technical data. The model furnished shall be not older than the manufacturer's current model on the date of invitation for bids.

3.1.1 Special requirements. In addition to the standard vehicle and components specified in 3.1, the vehicle shall be furnished with special equipment as specified herein.

* 3.1.1.1 Painting and marking. Treatment, painting, identification marking, and data plates shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-1223. The exterior color and the identification markings shall be in accordance with the military requirements of MIL-STD-1223 for the military service identified by the procuring activity (see 6.2).

* 3.1.1.1.1 Operating, caution and information plates. Operating, caution and information plates shall be furnished. Plates shall conform to MIL-P-514, Type III, composition H or C.

* 3.1.1.2 Rustproofing. When specified (see 6.2), the vehicle shall be rustproofed in accordance with FED-STD-297. When specified (see 6.2), tropical rustproofing in accordance with FED-STD-297 shall be furnished.

3.1.1.3 Drain plugs. All drain plugs installed throughout the vehicle for the purpose of draining lubricants and hydraulic fluids shall be of the permanent magnet type.

3.1.1.4 Wood treatment. Wood surfaces shall be treated in accordance with MIL-STD-1223.

3.2 General design.

3.2.1 Federal Motor Vehicle Safety Standards. The vehicle and furnished accessories shall comply with all Federal Motor Vehicle Safety Standards in effect on the date of manufacture.

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3.2.1.1 Curb weight. Curb weight of the vehicle shall include all attachments, accessories and equipment; full complement of fuel, fluids and lubricants.

3.2.1.2 Rated payload and weight distribution. Rated payload shall be 24,000 pounds, uniformly distributed over the elevating platform payload area as defined in table I.

3.2.1.3 Gross weight. Gross weight of the vehicle shall consist of the curb weight plus the payload.

3.2.1.4 Ratings. Vehicle ratings shall be the manufacturer's published rating. Component and vehicular ratings shall not be raised to meet the requirements of this specification. When published ratings are not available, verification of ratings must be submitted to the engineering office of the procuring activity.

* 3.2.1.5 Dimensions. Semitrailer dimensions and clearances, without payload, uncoupled from the towing vehicle, resting on the landing legs on level ground, and with the platform level in travel position, shall be as specified in table I. The overall length and width are exclusive of appurtenances.

TABLE I. General dimensions.

Description or location	Inches
Overall length, (minimum)	305
Overall width, plus zero minus 1 inch	96
Gooseneck:	
Length, front of vehicle to headboard, (minimum)	101
Kingpin, front of vehicle to center of kingpin, plus or minus 1 inch	18
Upper fifth wheel height from ground level, plus 2 inches, minus 0	46
Landing gear clearance:	
From centerline of kingpin to any portion of vehicle, 6 inches or more below upper fifth plate (minimum)	82
Elevating platform payload area:	
Length between gooseneck and wheel wells (minimum)	144
Width between side guard rails (minimum)	91
Ground clearance in travel position, (minimum):	
Vertical distance between road and underneath side of elevating platform main structural members:	14
Height, ground level to top of treadplate:	
Lowest position (minimum)	9 1/2
Travel position (plus or minus 1 inch)	22

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Description or location	Inches
Highest (elevated) position (minimum)	48
Elevating platform, rear access area:	
Length of wheel wells (minimum)	50 1/4
Width between wheel wells (minimum)	57
Forward swing radius:	
From centerline of kingpin to most distant point on semitrailer nose (maximum)	52

3.3 Performance. When fully equipped with and without rated payload evenly distributed over the elevating platform payload area as defined in table I and while being towed at speeds over roads as specified in 3.3.1, the vehicle and its hydraulic system shall exhibit capacity to withstand the static and dynamic forces developed. The platform frame, gooseneck, and all other components shall show no evidence of part failure or permanent set when subjected to the operating conditions specified herein.

3.3.1 Towing speed. The vehicle, fully equipped and loaded with rated payload, shall be capable of being towed at speeds up to 25 miles per hour (mph) over unimproved roads (see 6.3.2) and other reasonably hard, uneven terrain and at speeds up to 55 mph over improved roads (see 6.3.1).

3.3.2 Turning ability. The vehicle shall be capable of assuming a 90 degree angle to the coupled towing vehicle without cramping or damage to the towing vehicle or the towed vehicle. Turning ability shall be demonstrated with a towing vehicle having a tandem axle and the fifth wheel located at least 52 inches from the transverse plane, measured from the back face of the tires and a fifth wheel height of 48 inches to 54 inches. The towing vehicle shall have an inclined ramp located on the rear frame members to provide an approach for the upper fifth wheel plate. The inclined ramp vertical height at the rear of the fifth wheel plate shall be measured when the fifth wheel plate is tilted down to accept the upper fifth plate of the semitrailer. When a towing vehicle is not available with a ramp, a simulated ramp may be provided. Under these conditions the semitrailer, coupled to the towing vehicle, shall be capable of ascending and descending ramps of not more than 14 degrees.

3.3.3 Tracking ability. The vehicle shall conform with the tracking requirements of Federal Motor Carrier Safety Regulation 393.70(a).

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3.3.4 Braking ability.

* 3.3.4.1 Service brakes. The service brakes shall stop the semitrailer-tractor combination, with the semitrailer loaded with specified payload, within the stopping distance requirements of Federal Motor Carrier Safety Regulation 393.52.

3.3.4.2 Parking brakes. The vehicle parking brakes shall be capable of holding the vehicle on dry, hard-surfaced, 30 percent grade, up or down incline, when vehicle is uncoupled from the towing vehicle.

3.3.5 Loading. The vehicle shall be capable of being loaded from ground level and from loading docks. Loading shall be accomplished from the rear of the vehicle and from the curbside of the vehicle. Loading and unloading shall be demonstrated from the lowest level of the platform to the highest level of the platform as specified in table I. Heights shall be measured vertically from ground to top of the elevating platform payload area, as defined in table I.

3.3.6 Hydraulic system. The vehicle hydraulic system shall be capable of meeting the performance requirements when the vehicle is subjected to the loading and operating conditions specified in 3.3 through 3.3.6.4.

3.3.6.1 Lifting speed. The hydraulic system shall be capable of raising the loaded platform from the lowest to the highest position specified in table I. Lifting speed shall be at a uniform rate and shall be not less than 40 inches per minute.

3.3.6.2 Lowering speed. The hydraulic system shall be capable of lowering the loaded platform from its highest elevated position to any attainable position at a uniform rate of descent of not more than 80 inches per minute.

3.3.6.3 Lateral stability. The vehicle shall maintain lateral stability during static and dynamic loadings with no evidence of any deformation which interferes with the smooth operation of the hydraulic system.

3.3.6.4 Lifting system overload. The hydraulic system shall be of sufficient capacity to withstand operation with specified overload evenly distributed over the elevating platform payload area, as defined in table I. No creep or part failure shall be evident after sustaining a 48,000 pound payload for 1 hour at an initial 48 inch elevation, nor after sustaining a 36,000 pound payload for 1 hour at an initial 24 inch elevation. Creep and settling shall be measured from the top of the platform at the centerline of the axle or bogie and at the headboard area. Hydraulic fluid shall be stabilized at ambient air temperature.

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3.4 Body assembly. The vehicle shall have an integral body frame assembly consisting of a hydraulically operated elevating platform and wheel wells. The gooseneck shall be integrally mounted to the elevating platform by hydraulically operated cylinder(s) and guides. Hydraulic cylinder(s) and guides shall be provided at the rear wheel suspension. The gooseneck shall be of sufficient width to accommodate the engine and hydraulic pump. The hydraulically operated winch and components shall be mounted on the gooseneck area.

3.4.1 Chassis components.

* 3.4.1.1 Wheels, rims, tires and tubes. The vehicle shall be equipped with wheels or rims and tires, as specified herein. Rim and tire ratings shall conform to Tire and Rim Association recommendations for the type and size of tire furnished. Tire and rim sizes shall be the same for all wheels on the vehicle. Tire size and load range (ply rating) shall be the same for all tires on the semitrailer. When specified (see 6.2), disc type wheels shall be furnished.

* 3.4.1.1.1 Tires. Tires shall be steel belted radial ply or, when specified (see 6.2), bias ply. Tires shall be tube or tubeless type with highway tread. Tires shall be of rated capacity at least equal to the load imposed on each tire, measured at each wheel at the ground, with vehicle loaded to specified gross weight. Tires shall conform to Tire and Rim Association recommendations or to ZZ-T-381 with a size designation system the same as the Tire and Rim Association.

3.4.1.1.2 Inner tubes. When tube type tires are furnished, inner tubes shall be of heavy duty type, and shall be of proper size for tire furnished. Tire flaps shall be provided for tube type tires in accordance with Tire and Rim Association recommendations.

* 3.4.1.1.3 Carrier for spare tire assembly. Unless otherwise specified, (see 6.2), a carrier for a spare wheel or rim and tire assembly shall be installed in a readily accessible location on the vehicle. Threaded fasteners, when used to secure the spare tire in the carrier, shall be constructed of or plated with corrosion-resistant material.

* 3.4.1.1.4 Spare wheel. When specified (see 6.2), a spare wheel or rim shall be mounted on the carrier and installed in a readily accessible location. Carrier shall permit removal or installation of spare assembly using only the tools specified in 3.11. When a spare tire assembly is specified (see 3.4.1.1.4), a spare wheel or rim shall be furnished.

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* 3.4.1.1.5 Spare tire assembly. When specified (see 6.2), a spare tire assembly shall be furnished. The spare tire assembly shall include an inflated spare tire mounted on the spare wheel or rim. The spare tire shall be of the same size, load range, (ply rating) and tread design as the tires furnished on the vehicle.

3.4.2 Suspension. Vehicle shall be equipped with a suspension system with components having a rated capacity at least equal to the load imposed on each member, measured at the ground, with the vehicle loaded with specified payload. Sufficient clearances shall be provided to preclude interference between wheels and with any other part of the vehicle under all operating conditions. The suspension system shall be capable of withstanding the resultant forces when the vehicle is in any attainable position. Suspension system need not be furnished with springs.

3.4.2.1 Axles. Each stub axle rating shall be at least equal to the load imposed on each stub axle, measured at the ground, with vehicle loaded with specified payload.

* 3.4.3 Brakes. The brakes shall be of the full-air internal expanding type and shall conform to Federal Motor Carrier Safety Regulations 393.40, 393.43, and 393.45 through 393.52. The brake system shall include piping, hose connections, gladhands, spring loaded dust covers or dummy gladhands equipped with security chains, air reservoirs (with remote operating control for the drain valve positioned above the bottom of the frame rail), automatic slack adjusters, brake chambers, a complete air-brake system. Gladhands shall conform to SAE J318. Location of air fittings shall be as recommended in SAE J702. All components of the braking system shall be installed in such a manner as to provide adequate road clearance when traveling over uneven or rough terrain, including objects liable to strike and cause damage to the brake system components. No part of the braking system shall extend below the bottom of wheel rims, to insure, in case of a flat tire, that the weight of the semitrailer will be supported by the rim and the flat tire and not be imposed on any components of the braking system. Slack adjusters and air chamber shall be located above the bottom edge of the axle carrier.

* 3.4.3.1 Parking brakes. The semitrailer shall be equipped with spring or air diaphragm mechanical lock type parking brakes. The parking brakes shall hold the semitrailer, with rated payload, on a 30 percent grade despite the depletion of the compressed air supply. The parking brakes shall be automatically applied upon disconnection of the emergency air line and under emergency conditions. The parking brakes shall conform to Federal Motor Carrier Safety Regulation 393.41.

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3.4.4 Landing gear. The vehicle shall have two vertical, steel wheeled or hinged steel pads, telescopic, nonrotating landing legs, with two speed gears, and a handcrank at the curbside. A holder shall be provided for handcrank when not in use. The landing gear shall withstand, without deformation, the combined static and dynamic forces during coupling, uncoupling and loading operations. When placed in travel position, the landing gear legs shall remain positively locked, and shall provide not less than 10 inches ground clearance. The landing gear shall be protected to preclude the entrance of foreign matter which would impair its functioning or mechanical efficiency. The landing gear shall have a range of adjustment sufficient to vary the height of the upper fifth wheel plate at the front of vehicle from the vehicle's lowest attainable position of the platform to not less than 53 inches from ground.

* 3.4.5 Electrical system. The electrical system shall be 12-volt potential. Wiring shall be in accordance with SAE 1292. All wiring exposed to possible physical damage shall be protected by the use of heavy wall thermoplastic insulated cable or conduit. Electrical cables passing through cross members or floor plates shall be provided with grommets and shall be supported to preclude chafing and vibration.

* 3.4.5.1 Lighting. All lights and reflectors shall be protected from operational hazards by mounting in recessed or otherwise guarded locations. Lights and reflectors shall not be mounted on vertical surfaces of the rub rail or on the semitrailer bumper (unless recessed and fully protected). Turn signal lamps shall conform to SAE J588. Clearance and identification lamps shall be constructed for easy removal and replacement of lamps and lenses without the use of hand tools.

3.4.5.1.1 Twelve-volt direct current (dc) system. A 12-volt dc lighting system conforming to 3.4.5.1 and 3.4.5.1.2 shall be provided. The 12-volt dc lighting system shall conform to Federal Motor Carrier Safety Regulations 393.14, 393.20, 393.22, 393.23, 393.25 through 393.29, 393.32 and 393.33.

3.4.5.1.2 Receptacle for 12-volt dc system. The front of the semitrailer shall be equipped with a 7-contact receptacle conforming to SAE J560 with the connectors connected and color coded as specified therein. The receptacle shall be provided with a spring loaded cover. The receptacle shall be located in accordance with SAE J702.

3.4.5.1.3 Independent 24-volt dc system. When specified (see 6.2), a 24-volt dc lighting system, independent of the 12-volt dc lighting system, shall be provided. Separate wiring and bulbs shall be provided for the 24-volt dc system. The system shall conform to

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3.4.5.1. The 24-volt dc system shall also conform to the Federal Motor Carrier Safety Regulations referenced in 3.4.5.1.1 except the 24-volt dc stop and turn lamps shall be combined.

3.4.5.1.4 Interconnected 24-volt dc system. When specified (see 6.2), a capability of operating the 12-volt dc system (see 3.4.5.1.1) from a towing vehicle equipped with a nominal 24-volt dc electrical system shall be provided.

3.4.5.1.5 Resistors. When an interconnected 24-volt dc system is specified (see 3.4.5.1.4), the 12-contact receptacle (see 3.4.5.1.6) shall be provided with resistance to each circuit to reduce the voltage of the tactical towing vehicle from a nominal 24 volts dc to 12 volts dc. Each circuit resistor shall be selected to reduce the voltage of the tactical truck to within the maximum rated voltage of the semitrailer electrical components. The resistor assembly shall be located in a protective housing and provided with adequate ventilation or a heat sink to preclude overheating and any damage to resistors, wiring, or adjacent components.

* 3.4.5.1.6 Receptacle for 24-volt dc system. When either an independent (see 3.4.5.1.3) or interconnected (see 3.4.5.1.4) 24-volt dc system is specified, the front of the semitrailer shall also be equipped with a 12-contact receptacle and cover conforming to MS75021, part number MS75021-1. The receptacle shall be located in accordance with SAE J702. The 24-volt dc, 12-contact receptacle shall be connected to the lights as follows:

Contact B.	Connect to left-hand turn signal and stop lamp (yellow)
Contact D.	Connect to ground (white)
Contact E.	Connect to clearnace, side marker, identification, and tail lamps (black and brown)
Contact J.	Connect to right-hand turn signal and stop lamp (green)
Contact L.	Connect to ground (white).

The remaining contacts shall not be connected. Circuits B and J on tactical (military design) trucks are combination stop and turn indicator circuits. On the interconnected 24-volt dc system, the normal 12-volt dc turn signal lights will function both as turn signals and stop lights, and the normal 12-volt dc stop lights will not be operational when the semitrailer is connected to a towing vehicle with a 24-volt dc power supply. Because of this condition, the stop light (red) circuit is not connected to the 24-volt, 12-contact receptacle.

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* 3.4.5.1.7 Twelve-conductor lighting cable. When specified (see 6.2), a 12-conductor lighting cable, for either the interconnected or independent lighting system, shall be furnished. The cable shall be not less than 110 inches long when fully extended. Both ends of the cable shall be equipped with connectors conforming to MS75020-1 and MS75020-2. Provisions shall be made to secure the cable, when not in use, to the vehicle.

* 3.5 Frame. The main frame members supporting the lift platform, shall be one piece, without splices or joints. The main frame members shall support the imposed payload and the various load conditions when operating a fork lift truck on the lift platform. The fork lift truck will be considered as weighing 15,500 pounds (truck and payload). Under the mobile and loading conditions specified, the fiber stress shall not be greater than 50 percent of the yield strength of the materials used, and shall not result in any permanent deformation or warping of the frame structure. All parts of the chassis frame, where welding is required, shall be electric arc welded. The frame shall provide a 9 degree slope, plus or minus one-degree tolerance, for the rear of the frame at the location of rear loading ramp.

3.5.1 Platform. The platform shall be a level deck type. Platform shall have a supergrate or equal sub-floor, covered with safety steel tread plate of not less than 1/8 inch in thickness, exclusive of raised tread.

3.5.2 Wheelhousing. Wheelhousings shall be provided. The top surfaces shall be covered with safety steel tread plate of not less than 1/8 inch in thickness exclusive of the raised tread. Wheelhousing shall be constructed of sheet steel with sufficient bracing and supports. The wheelhousings shall inclose the area between the platform area, rear and forward of the wheels. The wheelhousings shall preclude road splash from entering onto the platform area.

3.5.3 Platform extension, beavertail. A beavertail shall be provided and shall be within the specified overall length of the vehicle. The beavertail shall have a length to provide a 9 degree slope plus or minus one degree tolerance. The beavertail shall have a supergrate or equal sub-floor, covered with safety steel tread plate of not less than 1/8 inch in thickness, exclusive of the raised tread.

3.5.4 Guard rails. Steel guard rails, not less than 8 inches high, shall be provided along the sides of the elevating platform. The guard rails shall extend from the front headboard to the rear wheelhousings, except for the area occupied by the side loading ramp (see 3.5.5). Guard rails shall be capable of being removed by one man without the use of tools.

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3.5.5 Side loading ramp. Side loading ramp with tread plate on the top surface shall be furnished. The ramp shall be manually operated by a hand operated ratchet-type locking winch. The winch shall be capable of locking, when winch arm is released by operator. The winch shall be located on the curb side of the vehicle. The ramp shall be of magnesium fabrication. The ramp shall have a terminal flare-out to provide for off-center approach; shall be not less than 54 inches in width at the hinged area; shall be of a length to form a 9 degree incline, plus or minus 1 degree tolerance, when loading from ground level; and shall be located with the forward edge within 35 inches rearward of the headboard. Side loading ramp shall have a maximum weight of 200 pounds plus hinges and winch accessories. The ramp shall be designed to support an axle load of 6,000 pounds. The ramp shall be provided with draw bolts, having a spring-loaded retaining catch to secure the ramp in a vertical position when in transit. The hinged end of ramp shall be level with the top surface of the elevating platform. Means shall be provided to lubricate rotating surfaces.

3.5.6 Rear loading ramp. A rear loading ramp with safety tread plate on the top surface shall be furnished. The ramp shall be manually operated by a hand operated, ratchet-type locking winch. The winch shall be capable of locking when the winch arm is released by the operator. The winch shall be located on the curb side of the vehicle. The ramp shall be of magnesium fabrication. The ramp shall have a terminal flare-out to provide for off-center approach; shall be centrally located; shall be not less than 54 inches in width at the hinged area; and shall be of a length to form a 9 degree incline plus or minus 1 degree tolerance, when loading from ground level. The rear loading ramp shall have a maximum weight of 150 pounds plus hinges and winch accessories. The ramp shall be designed to support an axle load of 6,000 pounds. The ramp shall be provided with draw bolts on each side having a spring-loaded retaining catch to secure ramp in a vertical position when in transit. The hinged end of the ramp shall be level with the top of the surface of the elevating platform. Means shall be provided to lubricate rotating surfaces.

3.5.7 Gooseneck. A gooseneck shall be provided. The frame members and their attachments to the lifting platform shall be capable of accepting the imposed loading conditions under the various operating conditions specified herein. The fiber stress shall not be greater than 50 percent of the yield strength of the materials used and shall not result in any permanent deformation or warping of the frame. The gooseneck shall be secured to the hydraulically operated guides of the lifting platform. The gooseneck platform shall have a supergrate or equal sub-floor covered with a safety steel tread plate of not less than

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1/8 inch in thickness exclusive of the raised tread. The gooseneck shall house the gasoline engine, hydraulic pump, winch components and accessories.

3.5.8 Upper fifth wheel plate. A fifth wheel plate shall be provided. The underside of the fifth wheel plate to ground level shall be as specified in table I, measured from the underside of the fifth wheel, with vehicle level and without load. The upper fifth wheel plate shall be reinforced, one-piece type, not less than 1/4-inch thick having sufficient bearing area to cover a 36-inch diameter fifth wheel on the tractor and shall be in accordance with Federal Motor Carrier Safety Regulation 393.70(b). The forward end of the upper fifth wheel plate shall have a turned up lip for ease of coupling and for protection of body. The upper fifth wheel plate shall be provided with a kingpin. The kingpin shall be located as specified in table I and shall be in accordance with SAE J700. The kingpin shall be fabricated of heat treated steel alloy.

3.5.9 Stowage compartment. A weatherproof stowage compartment, with arrangements for locking shall be provided. The stowage compartment shall be of all steel construction and the access door shall be of sufficient strength and have characteristics to prevent distortion or drumming while in transit. The stowage compartment shall be of sufficient size for the accessories and tools required for the vehicle. The stowage compartment shall be accessibly located on the gooseneck of the semitrailer. Drain holes shall be provided in the bottom of the stowage compartment.

3.5.10 Chock blocks. Chock blocks with chain attached shall be provided for the curbside and street side wheels. Chock block shall be of wood or metal. A chain of sufficient length to attach to vehicle and chock block to block wheels shall be provided. Chain shall be of adequate size to prevent pilferage. Adequate storage for chock blocks shall be provided on the curbside and streetside near the wheels.

3.5.11 Platform lift safety control. A hydraulic platform lift safety control device shall be provided. The device shall preclude operation of the lift platform (raising or lowering) unless the semitrailer brakes are in the locked position.

3.5.12 Guide and lifting rams. The guides shall maintain alinement of semitrailer wheels, frame and gooseneck during the lifting and lowering operation. The lifting rams shall withstand the forces and pressure developed during static and dynamic loading of the semitrailer without strain or resultant distortion.

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3.5.13 Front and rear suspension locks. There shall be two air operated locking devices, one on each side, at the rear of the elevating platform, and one air operated locking device at the front of the elevating platform to provide approximately 14 inches of road clearance with a uniformly distributed payload of 24,000 pounds in the loaded position. The locks shall support the sprung weight. The front and rear locking devices shall be controlled by one lever and spring loaded in the "loaded" position. The locking devices shall be actuated with the motion of one lever. A positive lock shall be provided to hold the lever in either the locked or unlocked positions.

3.5.14 Mud flaps. Manufacturer's standard mud flaps shall be provided to the rear of the rear wheels in accordance with SAE J682. A metal strip of not less than 1/8 inch wide, extending the entire width of the mud flap, shall be used as a backing to preclude bolt head or bolt nut from rupturing the mud flap during tightening operation upon installation.

3.6 Gasoline engine. An air cooled gasoline engine shall be provided to drive the hydraulic pump assembly. The engine shall be mounted on the gooseneck in conjunction with the hydraulic pump. Mounting shall be so as to minimize transfer of vibration. The engine shall have sufficient output power to drive all operating components. During normal operating conditions, the continuous-duty horsepower output required by all components and accessories driven by the engine shall not exceed 75 percent of the full throttle rating of the engine. The size and weight of the engine assembly shall be held to a minimum consistent with the performance requirements specified herein.

* 3.6.1 Engine components. The engine shall be a four cycle engine equipped with at least the following components:

(a) Magneto or distributor type ignition
(b) Self-starter, 12-volt
(c) Resistor-type spark plugs
(d) Oil bath air cleaner
(e) Automatic choke
(f) Generator, 12-volt, not less than 25 amperes
(g) Battery, 12-volt, not less than 55 amperes at a 20 hour rate. (Battery shall be of the maintenance free type having the maintenance free characteristics listed in W-B-131.)

3.6.2 Engine control panel. The engine accelerator, key-operated ignition switch, and the palm button starter shall be installed in a weather and waterproof cabinet on a control panel, each identified as to their function.

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3.6.3 Electrical system. The electrical system shall conform to Federal Motor Carrier Safety Regulations 393.30 through 393.33.

3.6.3.1 Lights. In addition to lighting specified, lights with guards and toggle switches suitable to illuminate the main hydraulic control panel, winch control, and engine control panel shall be furnished.

3.6.4 Fuel pump. A fuel pump shall be furnished on the engine and when lifting fuel against a head of 4 feet, the pump shall have sufficient capacity to supply the engine at its maximum rated load. An in-line gasoline fuel filter shall be provided, either as a component of the fuel pump or between fuel pump and carburetor.

3.6.5 Governor. A variable-speed governor shall be furnished. The governor shall automatically control the engine speed at the selected rated speed at all fluid pressure and flows required. A manually operated hand throttle shall control the engine at all speeds from the manufacturer's recommended minimum governed speed up to the maximum operating speed.

* 3.6.6 Exhaust system. The exhaust system shall be furnished with spark arresting muffler and means shall be provided to vent exhaust fumes away from operating personnel. The spark arrester shall have an 80 percent arresting efficiency when rated in accordance with SAE J350.

3.6.7 Engine fuel tank. An engine fuel tank shall be furnished. The fuel tank shall have a capacity to provide fuel for at least 8 hours of full-load operation. The fuel tank cap shall be painted red and shall be attached to the tank by means of a chain. A sump shall be provided in the fuel tank suitable for collection and accumulation of water. A drain shall be so located at the bottom of the sump for complete drainage of the fuel tank. Drainage shall be provided to preclude spillage of fuel on any area of the vehicle. The tank filler shall be provided with a protective screen and vent. A shut-off valve shall be provided in the line to the power source and shall be adjacent to the fuel tank. A photo-etched corrosion resistant plate shall be marked denoting the type of fuel to be used and shall be located in a conspicuous place near the filler cap.

3.6.8 Control panel. The control panel shall have a waterproof door and lock. This panel shall have the necessary controls to operate and control the lifting mechanisms of the semitrailer. A pressure sensitive adhesive type tape with high adhesion qualities similar to type I, class 1 of MIL-M-43719 shall be furnished to depict control usage in the cabinet. The controls shall be panel mounted.

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3.7 Hydraulic system. The hydraulic system shall consist of the components required to perform all hydraulic operations of the semitrailer with the degree of control specified herein. Mechanisms and reservoirs shall be positioned or shielded to prevent hazardous fluid contact with heated surfaces or electrical apparatus. An accumulator may be used as a component of the hydraulic system to provide the maximum degree of temperature control under continuous service.

3.7.1 Cylinders. All hydraulic cylinders shall incorporate seals to prevent entrance of moisture and dirt into the cylinders and leaks of hydraulic fluid from the cylinders. Packing (O type) shall be used in the cylinders where static seals are required. Manufacturer's standard seals shall be furnished where applied to reciprocating parts. Means shall be provided to install pressure gages for testing hydraulic system pressure and relief settings.

3.7.2 Hydraulic lines and fittings. Hydraulic lines shall be located to facilitate maximum ease of removal and installation, visual inspection for failures and maximum protection from damage during operation of the platform assembly. Hydraulic lines shall be seamless steel hydraulic tubing or wire braid hose with permanently attached fittings. Flexible, hydraulic hose shall be used where flexing of hydraulic lines is encountered and where installation of components requires a flexible coupling. Standard straight-thread, flared type, or adaptions to flared type or dry seal type fittings shall be furnished. Hydraulic lines and fittings shall be air and liquid tight and shall be installed to preclude vibrations and chafing. The system shall be designed to preclude hydraulic transients. Provisions shall be made for bleeding air from the hydraulic system and completely draining all hydraulic lines, when necessary. A manual type bleeder shall also be provided as on-vehicle-equipment on closed-center systems. Hose assemblies and all seamless steel hydraulic lines shall be adequate to provide the rate of flow, temperature and pressures required to operate the system smoothly and efficiently. Galvanized pipe and copper tubing shall not be acceptable. A shock proof hydraulic pressure gage shall be provided on the discharge side of the hydraulic pump.

3.7.3 Pump. A hydraulic pump with necessary pressure and flow capacity to operate all hydraulic powered components shall be provided. The hydraulic pump shall be driven by an air-cooled engine. Chain drives shall not be used. The pumping system shall include an adjustable pressure relief valve or unloading valve with the range of adjustment which allows raising of the platform with any working of test loads specified herein.

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3.7.4 Reservoir. A hydraulic fluid reservoir shall be provided and shall have sufficient capacity to hold the required volume of hydraulic fluid, with not less than 10 percent expansion space. The reservoir shall be provided with a filler opening and removable oil strainer and a vented filler cap, accessibly located to facilitate filling the tank from 1 gallon container using a funnel. The vented filler cap shall have means to preclude fluid from splashing out of tank during movement of vehicle. The filler cap shall be attached to the tank by a chain to prevent loss. Provision shall be made for inspection and cleaning of interior and draining of the reservoir. The reservoir drain shall be so located that the fluid will not drain on other components of the semitrailer and shall allow recovery of the fluid in a container. The reservoir shall have a photo-etched corrosion resistant plate to indicate type of hydraulic fluid furnished and the maximum fluid level in the reservoir with the semitrailer platform on travel or full extended position and the hydraulic lines and components full of fluid. A sight level or dip stick gage shall be furnished to observe level of fluid.

3.7.5 Oil filters. A mesh strainer shall be furnished in the line on the outlet side and a micro filter shall be furnished in the return line. Filters shall be easily accessible for periodic cleaning, or for replacing of filter cartridge. Filters shall have sufficient capacity to allow the maximum rated pump discharge.

3.7.6 Hydraulic fluid temperature. The hydraulic fluid temperature shall be maintained within safe limits to preclude seal damage or approach to flashpoint of the fluid during all operating conditions of the semitrailer for long periods of time. Excessive heating, approximately 180 degrees Fahrenheit (°F), of the fluid shall not be acceptable under any operating conditions. Provisions shall be made to prevent malfunction or unactuated operation of the hydraulic control system due to changes in fluid temperature.

3.7.7 Control valve. The control valve shall be of tapered spindle design to allow control over the rate of descent of the loaded semitrailer bed. The control valve shall contain a relief valve to govern the hydraulic pressure and the flow rate. It shall be self-centering to neutral position which shall allow pump delivery to circulate to the oil reservoir.

3.7.8 Safety valves. A set of safety or unloading valves shall be installed in the hydraulic system to prevent overloading and subsequent damage of the hydraulic equipment. The safety valve shall be preset so as to unload at a pressure over and above that required for the rated capacity load.

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3.7.9 Velocity valves. The hydraulic system shall be provided with velocity valves to prevent the semitrailer bed from collapsing if a hydraulic line should rupture. These valves shall be located at the inlet port of each lifting cylinder.

3.7.10 Pressure gages. Pressure gages shall be shock proof and shall be installed at the discharge port of the hydraulic pump and at the inlet of the filter on the return line to the reservoir.

3.8 Winch. A hydraulically operated winch, with not less than two speeds, having a maximum single line capacity of not less than 10,000 pounds pull on the bare drum shall be provided. The winch shall be powered from the gasoline-engine driven hydraulic power source. A control lever shall be furnished. The winch control lever shall provide smooth operation and shall be self-centering and shall revert to a neutral position when released by the operator. The winch shall be mounted on the gooseneck of the semitrailer. Wire rope shall be provided and shall be not less than 9/16-inch, improved plow steel, 6 by 37 hemp core, preformed, regular lay, with chain and sling hook at the end. Cable shall be not less than 105 feet long. Roller and guide shall be provided on the headboard of the lifting platform to preclude cable damage. The winch shall be provided with an anchor to retain the hook while the semitrailer is traveling. Winch guard shall be provided to protect the cable from lash.

3.9 Radio interference suppression. Vehicle shall be suppressed to limit electromagnetic radiation in accordance with SAE J551.

3.10 Lubrication system. Lubrication system shall be furnished with fittings for all bearings and other working parts which require relubrication for continued service. The semitrailer shall be lubricated, prior to delivery, with applicable grade of standard lubricant for the ambient temperature encountered at delivery point.

3.11 Tools. When specified (see 6.2), semitrailer shall be furnished with tools required for exchanging mounted tire assembly with spare assembly (see 3.4.1.1.3) and shall include at least a hydraulic jack, jack handle, and wheel-nut wrench. The jack shall be of such closed height as to permit its location under axle, or other satisfactory lift point, at any wheel with the tire flat. The jack, without blocking, shall be capable of raising any wheel of loaded vehicle to a height adequate to permit removal and replacement of wheel and tire assembly.

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3.12 Instruction plates. A photo-etched corrosion resistant plate showing a schematic of all valves, valve controls, cylinders and equipment and complete operating instructions for operating the semitrailer shall be securely fastened in a protected location. In addition, each control lever shall be marked with a photo-etched corrosion-resistant plate depicting the function of the control. Individual marking shall be adjacent to the controls. Instruction plates shall be provided for all exterior mounted controls.

3.13 Servicing and adjusting. Prior to acceptance by the Government inspector, contractor shall service and adjust semitrailer for operational use including at least the following: proper adjustment of the brake system, inflation of all tires, complete lubrication of chassis and running gear with grades of lubricant recommended for the ambient air temperature at the delivery point and service and cycling of the hydraulic lift mechanism.

3.14 Safety. All equipment or exposed portions of the equipment which are subject to extreme temperatures and inclement weather, and all rotating or reciprocating parts which are of such nature or located as to become a hazard to operating personnel, shall be insulated, fully-inclosed, shielded or properly guarded.

3.15 Workmanship. The quality and workmanship of all component parts, including fabricated parts, machined parts and casting shall be commensurate with sound manufacturing standards for similar equipment. The semitrailer shall be free from all burrs, sharp edges, die, tool and metal handling marks, rust, scale, leaks and cracks. Improper manufacturing or assembling practices and defective components or parts and assemblies which have been modified to overcome deficiencies shall not be furnished.

3.15.1 Welding. The surface of parts shall be free of rust, scale, paint, grease, or other foreign matter. Weld penetration shall be such as to provide transference of maximum design stress through the base metal juncture. Fillet welds shall be provided when necessary to reduce stress concentration.

3.15.2 Machine work. All parts shall be manufactured to gage through the use of proper jigs and fixtures, and shall require interchangeability of parts so manufactured.

3.15.3 Castings. Castings shall be sound and free from patching, misplaced coring, warping, or other defects which might render the castings unsound for use.

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4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

* 4.1.1 Responsibility for compliance. All items must meet all requirements of sections 3 and 5. The inspection set forth in this specification shall become a part of the contractor's overall inspection system or quality program. The absence of any inspection requirements in the specification shall not relieve the contractor of the responsibility of assuring that all products or supplies submitted to the Government for acceptance comply with all requirements of the contract. Sampling in quality conformance does not authorize submission of known defective material, either indicated or actual, nor does it commit the Government to acceptance of defective material.

4.2 Government verification. Quality assurance operations performed by the contractor will be subject to Government verification at unscheduled intervals. Verification will consist of observation of the operations to determine that practices, methods, and procedures of the contractor's inspection are being properly applied. Failure of the contractor to promptly correct product deficiencies discovered shall be cause for suspension of acceptance until correction has been made or until conformance of product to specification criteria has been demonstrated.

4.3 First production vehicle inspection. The first production vehicle produced under the contract shall be inspected by the contractor at his plant under the direction and in the presence of Government representatives. The purpose of the inspection shall be to determine vehicle conformity with the contract. Acceptance of the first production vehicle shall not constitute a waiver by the Government of its rights under the provisions of the contract.

4.3.1 Vehicle and payload capacity. The first production semitrailer shall be weighed to determine curb weight and distribution of curb weight on the kingpin and rear axle. The imposed loading on the kingpin and axle shall be computed using the curb weight and the payload evenly distributed over the platform area. Calculated imposed loads on

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the kingpin and rear axles shall be utilized to ascertain that the suspension and axles furnished are of adequate capacity to meet contract requirements.

* 4.3.2 Road test. The first production semitrailer shall be examined and road tested with and without payload in accordance with Table II.

Table II. Road Test

Number of Vehicles Procured	Mileage of First Production Road Test
1 - 10	100
11 - 20	200
21 - 30	300
31 - 40	400
41 - 50	500
51 - 100	1000
101 - up	5000

The road test shall be conducted by the contractor under direction and surveillance of Government representatives to assure the semitrailers will operate in accordance with contract requirements. The distance traveled shall consist of improved (see 6.3.1) and unimproved roads (see 6.3.2) with sharp turns and rocks. The semitrailer coupled to a truck tractor shall be driven at speeds up to 55 mph on improved roads for 40 percent of the road test mileage without payload and 35 percent of the road test mileage with payload. The semitrailer coupled to a truck tractor shall be driven at speeds 20 to 25 MPH on unimproved roads for 15 percent of the road test mileage without payload and 10 percent of the road test mileage with payload. For each 30 miles of travel at least one sudden stop shall be accomplished. Upon completion of the road test, the vehicle shall be inspected for leakage, weld quality, permanent deformation, misalignment or any other defects and refurbished prior to offering for Government acceptance.

4.3.2.1 Turning ability test. A truck-tractor shall be coupled to the semitrailer and driven through turns up to 90 degrees right and left to determine conformance to 3.3.2.

4.3.2.2 Brake tests. The semitrailer, carrying the rated payload and coupled to a truck-tractor, shall be driven on smooth, dry, level pavement and brakes applied from a speed of 20 miles per hour (mph), to determine conformance to the stopping distance required in 3.3.4.1. Breakaway situation shall be simulated to verify braking ability upon breakaway.

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4.3.2.3 Parking break test. The semitrailer, with rated payload, shall be placed on a 30 percent grade, first heading up the grade and then heading down the grade, and tested to determine conformance to 3.3.4.2. These tests shall be conducted with the semitrailer disconnected from the towing vehicle and resting on the landing legs.

4.3.3 Electrical test. An electrical test shall be conducted on the first production vehicle to determine that all vehicle lights are functioning. In addition, when an interconnected 24-volt system is furnished (see 3.4.5.1.4), the circuits of the 12-contact receptacle shall be energized with not less than 28 volts dc regulated voltage for a time sufficient to stabilize the temperature of the resistor assembly for not less than 30 minutes in an ambient temperature of not less than 77°F. After the test, the resistor assembly, including resistors, wiring and adjacent components shall be examined for evidence of overheating, deterioration or damage.

4.3.4 Platform tests.

4.3.4.1 Creep test. With the semitrailer on a level plane and with loads specified in 3.3.6.4, evenly distributed on the platform area as defined in 3.2.1.2, the platform shall be raised to at least 48-inches above the ground level, measured from ground level to top of platform, and held in that position for not less than 60 minutes. The platform shall be lowered to a 24-inch elevation and shall be held in that position for not less than 60 minutes. The semitrailer platform shall show no evidence of creep, leakage or part failure of any component. The creep and settling test shall be measured with the hydraulic fluid at ambient air temperature.

4.3.4.2 Speed test. With the semitrailer platform resting on level ground, the platform shall be loaded with specified payload (see 3.2.1.2), and the platform shall be elevated to its maximum height and lowered back to ground level as specified in 3.3.6.1 and 3.3.6.2. Speed test shall be measured with the hydraulic fluid at ambient air temperature.

4.3.5 Radio frequency suppression verification. The vehicle manufacturer shall indicate on the questionnaire (commercial vehicle engineering data), if the vehicle will be suppressed to limit electromagnetic radiation in accordance with SAE J551.

4.3.6 Production sample. Upon acceptance of the first production vehicle, it shall remain at the manufacturing facility as a production sample, and shall be the last vehicle shipped on the contract. The contractor shall maintain the vehicle in a serviceable condition for the duration of the contract.

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4.3.7 Failure. Failure of the first production vehicle to meet requirements of the contract shall be cause for the Government to refuse acceptance of all vehicles under the contract until corrective action has been taken.

4.4 Inspection of production vehicle. The contractor's inspection system shall as a minimum assure that the vehicle conforms to the physical and dimensional requirements and is capable of meeting performance requirements contained herein.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Vehicle processing. Vehicle shall be processed for shipment, from manufacturer's plant to initial receiving activity, in accordance with the manufacturer's standard commercial practice.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The vehicle covered by this specification is intended for general administrative use by the Government in transporting freight and lift trucks on various bases. The vehicle is not intended for general highway use.

6.2 Ordering data. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
* (b) Identification of appropriate military service for painting (see 3.1.1.1).
* (c) Paint color, exterior, if other than specified, civil agencies only (see 3.1.1.1).
* (d) Exterior color selection after contract award, if required (see 3.1.1.1).
* (e) Identification of appropriate military service for marking (see 3.1.1.2).
(f) Concealed marking, if required (see 3.1.1.2).
(g) Rustproofing, if required (see 3.1.1.4).
* (h) Tropical rustproofing, if required (see 3.1.1.4).
(i) Disc type wheels, if required (see 3.4.1.1).
(j) Bias ply tires, if required (see 3.4.1.1.1).
* (k) Spare tire carrier, if not required (see 3.4.1.1.3).
* (l) Spare wheel or rim, if required (see 3.4.1.1.4).
* (m) Spare tire assembly, if required (see 3.4.1.1.5).
(n) Independent 24-volt dc system, if required (see 3.4.5.1.3).
(o) Interconnected 24-volt dc system, if required (see 3.4.5.1.4).
(p) Twelve-conductor lighting cable, if required (see 3.4.5.1.7).
(q) Tools, if required (see 3.11).

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6.3 Definitions.

6.3.1 Improved roads. An improved road is a smooth, hard surfaced road, such as a concrete or asphalt paved highway.

6.3.2 Unimproved roads. An unimproved road is an unpaved, unstabilized road with an undulating surface, having occasional chuckholes and exposed rocks.

6.4 Identification of changes. The margins of this specification are marked with an asterisk to indicate where changes (additions, modifications, corrections, deletions) from the previous issue were made. This was done as a convenience only and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and contractors are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire content irrespective of the marginal notations and relationship to the last previous issue.

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(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ USER
	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)*:

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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